Thomar P. van Hees

thomarvanhees.github.io | van.hees.thomar@gmail.com

Education

Tor Vergata University of Rome, Italy 2021-2026
PhD in Economics and Finance

- Dissertation: *Essays in Banking and Monetary Theory*
- PhD awarded September 2026, with excellent classification
- Advisor: Fabrizio Mattesini
- External Committee
  Leo Ferraris, University of Milano-Bicocca
  Mariana Rojas Breu, Paris 2 Panthéon-Assas University

Católica Lisbon School of Business and Economics, Portugal 2017-2019
MSc in Economics

- Magna cum laude/with honours

University of Groningen, The Netherlands 2014-2017
BSc in Economics and Business

References

Professor Fabrizio Mattesini
Tor Vergata University of Rome
mattesini@economia.uniroma2.it

Assistant Professor Paolo Varraso
Tor Vergata University of Rome
paolo.varraso@uniroma2.it

Assistant Professor Andrey Alexandrov
Tor Vergata University of Rome
andrey.alexandrov@uniroma2.it

Research Interests

Monetary Economics, Banking, Macroeconomics, Financial Regulation, Payment Instruments, and Search Theory

Job Market Paper

Traditional vs. Shadow Banking in a Monetary Economy

Why do some depositors fund traditional banks while others fund shadow banks? This paper develops a monetary model of banking to provide an information-based explanation for the coexistence of traditional and shadow banks. Depositors can either monitor banks ex ante, at a cost that differs across households, or rely on costly ex post verification. Shadow banks attract depositors who monitor, while traditional banks attract depositors who rely on verification. The key mechanism links money demand to monitoring incentives: monitoring depositors earn a higher deposit rate and hold more money, which affects aggregate liquidity and the size of the shadow banking system, which in turn affects the incentive to monitor. In symmetric pure-strategy equilibria, this feedback rules out shadow banking when monitoring costs are identical. With heterogeneous monitoring costs, monitoring decisions are either strategic complements or substitutes depending on the nominal interest rate. The model predicts a non-monotone response of the size of the shadow banking system to changes in the nominal interest rate. Because households ignore their effect on aggregate liquidity and on verification costs, the shadow banking system is too large at low interest rates and too small at high interest rates.

Working Papers

1. **Interbank Trade, Liquidity Reallocation and Welfare in a Monetary Economy**
   with Paolo Varraso
   R&R at Macroeconomic Dynamics
   We study the positive and normative implications of interbank trade in a monetary economy in which banks require liquidity to finance stochastic investment opportunities. We characterize abundant- and scarce-liquidity equilibria and show how interbank trade affects investment, monetary transmission, and welfare.
2. **Multidimensional Stock Market Liquidity and Business Cycles**
   with Willem F.C. Verschoor and Luca M. Rolla
   Submitted
   We examine the relationship between different dimensions of stock-market liquidity and business cycles using seven liquidity measures and a factor model. We find that liquidity contains information about future US economic conditions, with some liquidity dimensions providing substantially more information than others.

Policy Publications

van Hees, Thomar P. (2018) Basisinkomen – Gratis Geld voor iedereen: wie betaalt? (Basic Income – Free Money for everyone, who pays?), *Liberale Reflecties*

Work in Progress

1. Bank Risk Taking with Demandable Deposits
2. Asymmetric Information, Liquidity, and Fire Sales
3. Search, Price Dispersion, and Prominence
   with Stylianos Daskalinas

Professional Experience

Department of Financial Stability, Ministry of Finance, The Netherlands 2020-2021
Policy Advisor/BoFEB Trainee

- Selected for the BoFEB post-master traineeship for young economists, in collaboration with Erasmus University Rotterdam.
- Prepared and coordinated regular meetings with De Nederlandsche Bank on financial regulatory issues.
- Prepared and participated in negotiations on European financial regulation, including the Central Securities Depositories Regulation and Financial Collateral Directive.

TeldersStichting, The Netherlands Summer 2019
Research Intern

- Participated in meetings on the development of policy proposals.

Conferences, Workshops, and Summer Schools *(* presented)*

2026	Summer Workshop on Money, Banking, Payments, and Finance*	Study Center Gerzensee
2025	3rd Macro-Finance Workshop*	University of Bern
2023	9th International PhD Meeting in Economics*	University of Macedonia
2023	14th Annual Financial Market Liquidity Conference*	Corvinus University
2023	2nd Rome PhD in Economics and Finance Conference*	EIF, Tor Vergata, and Luiss University
2023	Princeton Initiative: Macro, Money, and International Finance	Princeton University
2022	Summer School: Computational Macroeconomics	London School of Economics

Teaching

Tor Vergata University of Rome

- Teaching Assistant, *Advanced Macroeconomics II* (MSc), Andrey Alexandrov, 2023-2025
- Teaching Assistant, *International Economics* (MSc), Luisa Corrado, 2023

Luiss University

- Teaching Assistant, *Microeconomics* (BSc), Matteo Escudé and Emmanuel Tarantino, 2024

Academic Service

Referee, *Journal of Economic Dynamics and Control*
Scientific Committee, *Tor Vergata PhD Conference*

Skills

Languages: Dutch (Native), English (Fluent), Italian (Basic)
Technical Skills: MATLAB (Advanced), Stata (Advanced), LaTeX (Advanced), Dynare (Intermediate), Python (Basic)